



Jaspal helmed a highly successful Indian junior programme. He had been Manu's coach since she made her international debut in 2018.

A disagreement over the makeup of the squad [Jaspal wanted Manu to focus on two events, while she wanted to compete in three] was followed by court intrigues, the mother of all meltdowns and falling outs that involved a heated phone call and Jaspal walking around New

Delhi's Karni Singh shooting range in a t-shirt with Manu's mother's last caustic message to him printed on it.

In the years that followed Manu's debacle in Tokyo, her form fluctuated. She failed to win a medal in the individual events at the Hangzhou Asian Games, where Indian shooters went on to win two individual gold medals and four silver.

She says she became disillusioned with the sport. She started thinking about writing the Civil Service exam. Before that, though, as a last throw of the dice, she called Jaspal in the middle of last year. Jaspal immediately agreed to work with her. "I'll work with any athlete who gives a 100 per cent. Manu gives 100 per cent. And I will give her 200 per cent," he said.

We, as Indians, are glad that he did. They came together to deliver a fairytale performance that Indian sport was praying for.

Deadly duo: Last year, Manu Bhaker decided to return to her former mentor, Jaspal Rana, under whose tutelage she had bagged 10 senior WC medals (2018–2021) and a Commonwealth Games gold medal in 2018. RITU RAJ KONWAR